



Above Port barrels on traditional *barcos rabelos* (flat-bottomed barges) by the Dom Luís I bridge

Left Stiff as a board and almost as weatherproof, the split and dried salt cod can be seen hanging from shopfronts all over Portugal



Above *Bacalhau à espanhola* – “in the Spanish way” – cooked with peppers, potatoes, fresh tomatoes, white wine, garlic, and green olives

On the Port Wine Trail

Since the 18th century, port wine has been shipped downriver from the Douro vineyards to large quayside warehouses – lodges – in Porto, with historic company names that resonate through the ages. All offer fascinating tours (often free) of their premises, and at lodges like Sandeman (www.sandeman.eu), Cálem (www.calem.pt), and Ramos Pinto (www.ramospinto.pt), you can get to grips with the difference between a ruby, tawny, or vintage port before a tasting or two of their wines. There’s more information on the Port Wine Institute website (www.ivdp.pt), while the Rota do Vinho do Porto (www.rvp.pt) guides visitors on the Douro River “Port Wine Route.”

The Best Places to Eat Bacalhau

Dom Tonho expensive

Dom Tonho occupies a favored position on the Ribeira quayside, its dining room windows and outdoor terrace looking directly onto the Douro River and Dom Luís I bridge. It has a sleek look that marries stylish design with the building’s ancient, slabbed granite walls and arches, and visiting celebrities are very much on its radar, but for all its undoubted star attraction, it’s what comes out of the Dom Tonho kitchen that seals the deal. The exciting menu puts a contemporary twist on traditional Portuguese dishes, not least its own take on salt cod, *bacalhau à Dom Tonho*, in which the fish is fried with potatoes and eggs and served with garlic-sautéed onion, bacon, and cabbage. This or another *bacalhau* dish is always on the menu, while for an appetizer try the tantalizingly named *peixinhos da horta* (little garden fish), which are actually deep-fried green beans – nothing less than Portuguese-style tempura.

Cais da Ribeira 13–15, Porto; open 12:30–3 PM & 7:30–11:30 PM daily; www.dtonho.com

Also in Porto

Filha da Mãe Preta (+351 222 055 515; *inexpensive*) is one of the best-known traditional Portuguese restaurants on the Porto quayside, its tiled arches and river views forming a charming backdrop for local dishes, including a daily *bacalhau* choice. **Café Majestic** (www.cafemajestic.com; *moderate*), a gloriously decorated Art Nouveau café, also has *bacalhau* on its lunch menu, while a 30-minute metro ride from downtown takes you to the in-the-know suburb of Matosinhos for the city’s finest fish and seafood restaurants.

Also in Portugal

Virtually every restaurant in Portugal serves a *bacalhau* dish – favorites to look for include *bacalhau à brás* (fried, with egg, onion, and potatoes), *com natas* (baked with cream), and *com piri-piri* (cooked in chili pepper sauce). At Lisbon’s fashionable dockside **Bica do Sapato** (www.bicadosapato.com; *expensive*) they serve an unusual *bacalhau* risotto accompanied by deep-fried *bacalhau* fillets.

Around the World

Portuguese salt-cod preparations are rare outside the Portuguese-speaking countries, though *bacalhau* itself has traveled the world (as it was intended to) and turns up on menus as *bacalao* (Spain), *baccalà* (Italy), *klippfisk* (Norway), saltfish (Jamaica), and *morue* (France). In the Spanish capital, Madrid, one of the signature tapas dishes at the famous bullfighting tavern, **La Taberna de Antonio Sánchez** (+34 915 397 826; *inexpensive*), is *tortilla de San Isidro*, a classic *madrileño* salt-cod omelet.